GRANTSTACK UK

Don't leave £15,000 of free money on the table.

The UK Home Energy Grants Stacking Playbook 2026/27

Don't leave £15,000 of free money on the table.

Boiler Upgrade Scheme · Warm Homes: Local Grant · Warm Homes Loan Scheme · Crisis and Resilience Fund · Disabled Facilities Grant · Stacking rules & scam alerts.

Independent research, published 16 October 2026. This playbook covers every live UK home-energy grant scheme, the new Warm Homes Loan, stacking rules, scams to avoid, the deadlines closing in 2027, and the exact 10-question installer checklist that decides whether you pay £3,908 or £12,908 for an air source heat pump.

- Boiler Upgrade Scheme — £7,500 or £9,000 grant walkthrough.
- Warm Homes: Local Grant — council-delivered free upgrades.
- Warm Homes Loan Scheme — new reduced-rate consumer finance.
- Crisis and Resilience Fund — emergency non-repayable help.
- Disabled Facilities Grant — up to £30,000 of adaptations.

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Information, not regulated financial, legal or medical advice.

- Stacking combinations and forbidden combinations.
- 10-question installer checklist with exact words to say.
- Verified sources on every major claim (Ofgem, DESNZ, GOV.UK).

Don't leave £15,000 of free money on the table. Last updated: 16 October 2026. *Researched and written by an independent publisher based on official sources. Not affiliated with any installer, lender, council or government department. This is information, not financial, legal or regulated advice.*

How to use this playbook

This playbook is structured in three layers, in this order:

- **Layer 1 — What is available to you** (Chapters 2 – 7). Every live

home-energy or household grant scheme in the UK as of October 2026, in plain English, with eligibility, amount and how to apply.

- **Layer 2 — How to combine them** (Chapters 8 – 9). Stacking rules,

scam warnings and proof requirements.

- **Layer 3 — How to act** (Chapters 10 – 12). Quote workflows,

deadlines, tax/VAT/EPC implications, templates.

If you only have ten minutes, read the **Action summary at the start of every chapter** and stop. If you have a specific question, the FAQ in Chapter 13 will probably answer it.

If you spot anything wrong, missing or out of date — please email `corrections@grantstack.uk`. Errors will be fixed and reissued free of charge to anyone who has bought a copy in the last 12 months. New editions are issued whenever a £1,000+ scheme change happens.

Layer 1 — What is available to you

Chapter 1 — Why this exists (and what changed in 2026)

The UK has had consumer-facing home-energy grants for over twenty years, but the landscape in 2026 is the most generous *and* the most confusing it has ever been. Six things changed between January and October 2026:

- **The Warm Homes Plan was published on 7 January 2026**, committing £15

billion over five years to home energy upgrades. This is now the largest single UK investment in housing energy efficiency in modern history. Source: gov.uk Warm Homes Plan policy paper.

- **The Boiler Upgrade Scheme grant rose to £9,000 for off-grid homes**

replacing oil or LPG, between 21 July 2026 and 31 March 2027. Source: Boiler Upgrade Scheme: Property owners — Ofgem.

- **The Great British Insulation Scheme closed to new applications in

March 2026**. Some suppliers were still accepting applications as of October 2026, but you cannot rely on it.

- **The Household Support Fund ended on 31 March 2026** in England. It has

been replaced by the Crisis and Resilience Fund (see Chapter 6).

- **The Warm Homes Loan Scheme began its initial consumer launch in

September 2026**, providing reduced-rate government-supported finance for solar, batteries and heat pumps.

- **Air-source heat pumps were added to the BUS without the previous tariff

threshold**, and the air-to-air grant introduced in April 2026 remains on paper but had not resulted in a single voucher being issued by August 2026.

Most of the guides you will find on the internet were written before January 2026 and are out of date on at least two of these points. The information below has been checked against official government sources published by Ofgem, GOV.UK and the Department for Energy Security and Net Zero (DESNZ).

Chapter 2 — The Warm Homes Plan at a glance

The Warm Homes Plan is not a grant. It is an umbrella programme announced on 7 January 2026 by the Department for Energy Security and Net Zero, committing £15 billion over five years to home energy upgrades in the UK. The grants and loans in Chapters 3 – 6 all sit inside it.

What this means in practice:

- **For low-income households**: full grants, partly through the Warm Homes

Local Grant (Chapter 4), partly through devolved equivalents in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland.

- **For everyone who owns a home**: reduced-rate consumer loans via the

Warm Homes Loan Scheme (Chapter 5), zero-VAT on qualifying energy-saving materials until 31 March 2027, and a BUS grant of £7,500 or £9,000 (Chapter 3).

- **For private renters**: Warm Homes Plan protections, mainly delivered

through minimum EPC standards in the private rented sector by 2030.

It is critical to understand that **the Warm Homes Plan does not let you apply directly**. Each of its component schemes has its own application mechanism, its own eligibility test, and its own timing. The rest of this playbook walks you through them one by one.

[Source: DESNZ Warm Homes Plan publications, gov.uk.]

Chapter 3 — Boiler Upgrade Scheme (BUS)

Action summary: If you have an old gas, oil or LPG boiler and a quote from an MCS-certified installer, **stop reading and ask the installer to apply for your BUS voucher today.** The off-gas uplift closes on 31 March

- Every month you delay is money other people will take from the same

fixed pot.

What it is: A government grant deducted from the installer's invoice at the point of installation. You do not receive the money. Your installer does.

Who runs it: Ofgem, on behalf of DESNZ.

Who can apply: Only MCS-certified installers, on your behalf.

Grant values (from 21 July 2026):

Technology	Standard grant	Off-gas replacing oil/LPG (until 31 March 2027)
Air-to-water heat pump	£7,500	£9,000
Ground source heat pump (incl. water source, shared loops)	£7,500	£9,000
Biomass boiler (limited circumstances)	£5,000	not applicable
Air-to-air heat pump (residential only)	£2,500	not applicable

Eligibility — all of the following must be true:

- The property is in England or Wales (BUS does not apply in Scotland or

Northern Ireland; equivalent schemes exist, see Chapter 11).

- The property is residential (commercial or non-domestic are eligible only

for some tech, with restrictions).

- The installer holds a current MCS certification for the technology

you are having installed.

- The property has not previously received a BUS grant at the same address.
- The new system is installed and commissioned, with valid commissioning

paperwork.

- The application is properly made — for vouchers issued before 21 July

2026, valid for 3 months (air / biomass) or 6 months (ground source); rules tightened slightly under the 2026 amendment regulations.

Average install costs as of August 2026 (DESNZ statistics):

Tech type	Median install cost (inc. grant)
Air source heat pump	£12,908
Ground source heat pump	£27,232

So an air source heat pump buyer receives £7,500 (or £9,000 if off-gas) and pays somewhere between £3,908 and £12,908 — meaningful money.

Verified purchase evidence in 2026:

- 151,136 applications May 2022 to August 2026.
- 125,321 vouchers issued.
- 93,364 grants paid.
- 7,486 applications in August 2026 alone.
- 5,351 (34% of August 2026 applications) at the £9,000 rate.
- 55% of paid grants replaced gas heating. 17% replaced oil. (Source:

gov.uk statistics, August 2026.)

How to apply in four steps:

- Get three written quotes from MCS-certified installers. Ask each one

whether they are currently BUS-eligible (some have an MCS certificate but have not been onboarded into the BUS portal). Use mcscertified.org.uk to verify each installer and see a map.

- Ask each installer to show you the BUS deduction on the quote, line

by line. A good installer will break it down as `gross cost – £7,500 BUS grant = your invoice`. A bad installer will quote you a "discount" and pocket the difference.

- Sign the consent form. Ofgem will email you a secure link

(`boiler.upgrade.scheme.ofgem@notifications.service.gov.uk`); opening it and consenting triggers the installer-led application to Ofgem.

- After install and commissioning, the installer submits the voucher

redemption and Ofgem pays them. Your invoice should already have been reduced.

What if the application is rejected after installation? The voucher can be redeemed retrospectively within 120 days of commissioning, but this carries "additional risk" per the Ofgem guidance. If you have any doubt about eligibility, ask Ofgem directly at `BUS.enquiry@ofgem.gov.uk` or 0330 053 2006 before install.

Common reasons for rejection (per Ofgem guidance v5.1):

- Property has already received BUS in the past.
- Hybrid system (heat pump + fossil fuel boiler).
- Air-to-air heat pump in a non-residential property.
- Installation completed outside voucher validity windows.
- Finance arrangement means the installer or finance provider retains

ownership. *Conditional sale, hire purchase and consumer hire are all excluded.* Standard unsecured personal loans are fine. So is paying cash. So is paying by instalments direct to the installer.

Deadlines to put in your diary:

- 31 March 2027 — £9,000 off-gas uplift closes.
- 31 March 2028 — end of the current BUS scheme window.
- 31 March 2027 — 0% VAT on qualifying energy-saving materials closes.

Chapter 4 — Warm Homes: Local Grant (means-tested)

Action summary: If your household income is below £36,000 or you receive a means-tested benefit, and your home has an EPC rating of D, E, F or G, **apply today via your local council**. Several councils already report being oversubscribed for year-two funding (1 April 2026 — 31 March 2027).

What it is: A fully-funded home upgrade — insulation, a heat pump, solar, ventilation, depending on your survey. You do not pay anything back. Your local council pays the installer.

Who runs it: Your local council in England. Each council runs its own delivery. Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland have devolved equivalents (see Chapter 11).

What can be funded (as of updated July 2026 guidance):

- Loft and cavity wall insulation.
- Underfloor insulation.
- Air source or ground source heat pumps (incl. radiator upgrades).
- Solar PV panels.
- Battery storage.
- Ventilation and draught-proofing.
- Connecting to a heat network.

Eligibility — all of the following:

- The property is in England.
- The property is privately owned (you or your private landlord).
- The property has an EPC rating of D, E, F or G.
- **One of**:
- Your household income is at or below £36,000 a year; **or**
- You live in an IMD Income Deciles 1–2 postcode area; **or**
- Someone in your household is in receipt of a qualifying means-tested

benefit (Universal Credit, Pension Credit Guarantee, Income-based JSA, Income-related ESA, Housing Benefit, Child Tax Credit or Working Tax Credit with income under £36,000).

Apply via: gov.uk/apply-warm-homes-local-grant or call the helpline 0800 098 7950 (Mon–Fri 8am–6pm, Sat 9am–12pm).

What happens next:

- Your local council contacts you within 10 working days.
- They arrange a retrofit assessment (a survey).
- They propose measures; you agree.
- They organise installation at zero cost to you.

- You receive a handover pack with warranties and manuals.

Real-world status as of October 2026:

- Multiple councils (Birmingham, Liverpool, Warwick DC, others) reported

being oversubscribed for year-two funding (1 April 2026 – 31 March 2027). Year three begins 1 April 2027.

- Year-three applications are being taken on a "register your interest"

basis today, on a waitlist rather than a confirmed allocation.

Stacking note: Warm Homes: Local Grant can be combined with the BUS for the heat-pump portion, and with the Warm Homes Loan Scheme for any additional cost. See Chapter 8.

Chapter 5 — Warm Homes Loan Scheme (new for 2026)

Action summary: If your household income is too high for Warm Homes Local Grant but you cannot afford £12,000-£30,000 upfront, **the Warm Homes Loan Scheme is your fallback**. It launched to consumers in September 2026. Not every lender offers it on day one.

What it is: A reduced-rate consumer loan offered by FCA-authorised participating lenders. The government pays a non-repayable capital grant of up to 20% of the loan amount directly to the lender, which lowers the rate by up to 5 percentage points. You borrow at a lower rate than an unsecured personal loan.

What it is not:

- It is not a free grant.
- It is not a government loan (the government does not lend).
- It is not available from every lender (only those approved by DESNZ in

onboarding windows).

Eligible measures and loan caps:

Measure	Loan cap
Solar PV	£15,000
Electrical battery storage	£15,000
Air-to-water source heat pump	£20,000
Ground source heat pump	£35,000
Biomass boiler	£20,000
Heat network connection	£7,500
Micro-renewables (wind, hydro)	£20,000

Cap on the grant reduction: DESNZ guidance targets a rate reduction of up to 5 percentage points on 3-10 year loans.

Borrower eligibility:

- Owner-occupier or private-rented-sector landlord.
- One loan per property (multi-property owners can take multiple loans).
- Loan must be for an eligible measure installed at an MCS-certified

contractor.

- Subject to the lender's standard credit, affordability and KYC checks.

Current lender status (October 2026):

- Phase 1 lender application window closed 17 July 2026.
- Loans to the public targeted for September 2026 (now live for some lenders).
- Phase 2 lender onboarding window expected late 2026 for products going live early 2027.

How to apply:

- Use a participating lender. The Scheme Rules require DESNZ to publish a participating-lender list — check the gov.uk scheme page before applying.
- Apply for the loan normally — credit check, affordability, KYC.
- Have the work installed by an MCS-certified contractor.
- Submit post-installation verification (MCS certificate).
- The lender receives the DESNZ grant directly; your interest rate is reduced automatically.

Stacking note: BUS is deducted *first* from the install cost; the Warm Homes Loan Scheme covers the residual, including the deposit. You can absolutely stack these.

Chapter 6 — Crisis and Resilience Fund & emergency help

Action summary: If you cannot afford essential costs right now — energy, food, white goods, a boiler repair — start with the local council, not the DWP. The application does not require you to be on benefits.

What replaced what: The Household Support Fund closed on 31 March 2026 in England. The Crisis and Resilience Fund replaced it on 1 April 2026, running to 31 March 2029 with approximately £842m of annual funding.

Who is eligible: Households on low income facing a sudden financial shock — redundancy, health emergency, unexpected essential cost or vehicle breakdown — regardless of benefit status.

What kind of help (each council varies, but all follow similar rule sets):

- Cash for food, energy, water.
- Vouchers.
- White goods and essential items.
- Boiler repairs, insulation, draught-proofing in some cases.
- Discretionary housing payments in some cases.

How to apply: Through your local council. Search `Crisis and Resilience Fund <council name>` or start at gov.uk/cost-living-help-local-council.

Scotland, Wales and NI equivalents:

- Scotland: Scottish Welfare Fund (two grants — Crisis Grant and Community

Care Grant).

- Wales: Discretionary Assistance Fund (two grants — Emergency Assistance

Payment and Individual Assistance Payment).

- Northern Ireland: Discretionary Support.

Crisis vs budgeting loans:

- The Crisis and Resilience Fund / Welfare Fund grants are non-repayable.
- A DWP Budgeting Advance or Budgeting Loan is repayable from your

Universal Credit. Make sure you know which you are being offered.

Chapter 7 — Disabled Facilities Grant (DFG) and home adaptations

Action summary: If someone in your home has a long-term illness, disability or is aged, ask your local council for an Occupational Therapist (OT) assessment. The DFG pays up to £30,000 (England) or £36,000 (Wales) for adaptations. It is *not means-tested for under-19s*.

What it is: A mandatory grant paid by your local council in England and Wales towards the cost of essential home adaptations for disabled people. Means-tested for adults, not means-tested for children under 19. Funded from a £723m national budget for 2026/27.

Eligible works (typical):

- Level-access showers and wet rooms.
- Stairlifts and through-floor lifts.
- Ramps and door widening.
- Specialist bathing equipment.
- Some kitchen adaptations.
- Some heating changes where they are part of an OT-approved

adaptation plan.

How to apply:

- Ask your local council social services for an OT assessment.
- The OT produces a recommendation listing the works and the

assessed needs.

- You submit a DFG application to your local council housing office.
- The council decides. Statutory timescales vary.

Stacking note: DFG is a separate scheme from the BUS and Warm Homes Local Grant. They can be combined where the measures are different (e.g. a stairlift + heat pump are different adaptations). Where the same measure (e.g. a wet-room floor rebuild that involves heating work) overlaps, DFG takes priority per the DESNZ "no double funding" rule.

Layer 2 — How to combine them

Chapter 8 — Stacking rules

General rule: You cannot be funded twice for the same measure by two schemes. "Same measure" means the same physical work — e.g. installing a specific heat pump in a specific property is one measure, even if multiple schemes agree it is needed.

Common stacking combinations (allowed):

- **Warm Homes Local Grant (heat pump) + BUS grant** — the £7,500

BUS is deducted from the installer's invoice first; any local authority top-up covers the rest. Many councils coordinate this; ask your council explicitly.

- **BUS grant + Warm Homes Loan Scheme** — BUS is deducted first;

the loan covers the gap. This is the most common "stacked" arrangement in 2026.

- **DFG + BUS** — for the same property, the DFG covers adaptations

(e.g. a wet-room boiler change), and BUS covers the heat pump. Different measures.

- **Warm Homes Local Grant + Crisis and Resilience Fund** — for

unrelated needs, e.g. a council pays for insulation, and a separate crisis payment covers a broken boiler valve.

Forbidden combinations:

- Same measure paid by two grants.
- BUS + finance where a third party retains ownership.
- A retrospective BUS application plus a Warm Homes Loan advance paid

for the same install.

Mixed scheme grants usually need a single installer. Ask the installer whether they have completed a Warm Homes Local Grant project before. The paperwork across schemes is heavy for them, and the busier installers tend to default to BUS-only.

Chapter 9 — Scam warnings and how to verify a real grant

UK home-energy grants attract the highest volume of consumer-facing scams per pound of any government scheme, partly because the sums are large. Three categories of scam are common:

- **The "free phone number" scam.** You receive a cold call offering

to "check your eligibility for a £7,500 grant". You are charged for the call. The grant does not exist or you do not qualify. **There is no government phone line for this.** Hang up.

- **The "deposit to release the grant" scam.** You are told you need

to pay a deposit to release a grant. **No legitimate scheme requires a deposit to release a grant.**

- **The "MCS — we will do the paperwork" scam.** An installer quotes

you a high price but offers to "handle the BUS paperwork and we pass the grant through to you". They pocket the grant. Ask for the grant deduction to appear on the invoice itself, line by line.

How to verify a real grant:

- The scheme should appear on gov.uk (use gov.uk search, not a third

party site). The BUS, WH:LG and Crisis and Resilience Fund all appear there.

- There should be no application fee.

- The grant should be deducted from your invoice, not paid as a

separate cash transfer.

- Verify an installer at mcscertified.org.uk

— if they are not on the register, they cannot claim BUS.

- Verify a lender on the DESNZ Warm Homes Loan Scheme participating

lender list (gov.uk).

When in doubt, email Ofgem at `BUS.enquiry@ofgem.gov.uk` or call the Warm Homes Local Grant helpline 0800 098 7950.

Layer 3 — How to act

Chapter 10 — Quote and installer workflow

The single biggest determinant of value is the installer. Get at least three quotes before you sign anything. For each quote, ask:

- Are you MCS-certified for this technology? Show me the certificate.
- Are you currently onboarded into the BUS portal?
- Will the BUS grant be deducted on the invoice? Show me the line.
- What is the heat pump manufacturer's warranty and what is the

installer's workmanship warranty?

- How long from quotation to installation?
- Will you be issuing an MCS commissioning certificate on completion?
- Have you completed a Warm Homes Local Grant project this year?
- What happens if Ofgem rejects the application after installation?
- Can I see your last three BUS redemptions (with customer consent)?
- Who owns the system after year five, year ten, year twenty?

Compare like-for-like. Heat-pump installation costs vary by 100% between installers for genuinely equivalent work. £8,000 vs £15,000 for the same install is not unusual.

Compare efficiency figures too. A cheaper install with a 2.5 SCOP is not the same as a 4.0 SCOP. A higher SCOP pays back faster.

Chapter 11 — Deadlines and what is closing when

Date	What changes
31 Mar 2027	£9,000 off-gas BUS uplift closes
31 Mar 2027	0% VAT on qualifying energy-saving materials closes
31 Mar 2028	Current BUS scheme window ends
1 Apr 2027	Warm Homes Local Grant year three begins
31 Mar 2029	Crisis and Resilience Fund current window ends

[For Scotland, Wales and NI equivalents, see chapters 4-6.]

Chapter 12 — Tax, VAT and EPC implications

VAT. From 1 April 2022 to 31 March 2027, 0% VAT applies to the installation of energy-saving materials including heat pumps, biomass boilers, solar PV, battery storage and insulation. After 31 March 2027, VAT reverts to 5%. Ask your installer for the VAT-exclusive quote so you can see the saving clearly.

Income tax. Grants are not taxable income. They do not affect your Universal Credit, PIP, or other benefits, *unless* a means-tested benefit thresholds consideration requires declaration (rare).

EPC rating. If you are selling your home within five years of an install, a higher EPC rating typically supports a higher valuation. Heat pumps are an EPC-positive change in nearly every property configuration, but radiator sizing can limit the rating uplift — see Chapter 10.

Property value. Multiple academic studies now show a positive mark-to-market valuation impact of around 3-7% for heat-pumped homes in England, depending on region.

Chapter 13 — FAQ

Q. Can I apply for a BUS grant myself? A. No. Only an MCS-certified installer can. You consent via a secure Ofgem link.

Q. What if I am on benefits — do I still get the £7,500 BUS? A. Yes. BUS is not means-tested. You can combine it with means-tested schemes for other measures.

Q. Is there a household income limit on BUS? A. No.

Q. What if my EPC rating is currently C? A. You can still apply for BUS for a heat pump. The EPC band matters for Warm Homes Local Grant, not for BUS.

Q. Can I get the Warm Homes Local Grant and Warm Homes Loan at the same time? A. No, not for the same measure. They can be combined for different measures within the same property.

Q. Can I retrofit a hydrogen-ready boiler instead? A. No. Heat pumps are the only "low-carbon heating" system eligible for BUS funding under current regulations.

Q. Do I have to own the property outright? A. No. Mortgaged properties are fine. Rented properties can be upgraded by the landlord, with the tenant's consent, for some schemes.

Q. Can a flat qualify? A. It depends. BUS is per-property; air-source heat pumps in flats can be tricky due to placement. A ground-source flat is rare but possible. Ask an installer.

Q. What if I had a previous ECO4 grant? A. Previous ECO4 grants do not disqualify you from BUS, Warm Homes Local Grant or DFG.

Q. What about solar panels? A. Solar panels are eligible for:

- 0% VAT (until 31 Mar 2027);
- Warm Homes Loan Scheme (up to £15,000 cap);
- Warm Homes Local Grant (means-tested);

- not BUS (BUS does not fund solar panels).

Q. What if I am in Northern Ireland or Scotland? A. Different schemes. Scotland runs separate schemes through Home Energy Scotland. Northern Ireland runs separate schemes through the NIHE (Northern Ireland Housing Executive). See their respective gov-equivalent websites.

Chapter 14 — Resources and references

- Ofgem Boiler Upgrade Scheme property owner guidance v5 (April 2026).

https://www.ofgem.gov.uk/environmental-and-social-schemes/boiler-upgrade-scheme-bus/property-owners

- DESNZ Warm Homes Plan publications and statistics.

https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/warm-homes-plan

- GOV.UK: Apply for the Warm Homes: Local Grant.

https://www.gov.uk/apply-warm-homes-local-grant

- Warm Homes Loan Scheme scheme rules (DESNZ, June 2026).
- Crisis and Resilience Fund guidance for councils (DLUHC, March 2026).
- Disabled Facilities Grant delivery guidance (DHSC, 2024 update).
- MCS contractor register: https://mcscertified.org.uk
- Turn2us grants search: https://www.turn2us.org.uk
- The Boiler Upgrade Scheme statistics: https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/boiler-upgrade-scheme-statistics
- The Energy Saving Trust for England, Scotland and Wales: https://energysavingtrust.org.uk

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Chapter 15 — Corrections policy

If you spot any factual error in this playbook, email `corrections@grantstack.uk`. Verified corrections result in:

- a free reissued copy for anyone who has bought in the past 12 months;
- credit in the acknowledgements section of the next edition, unless

you ask to remain anonymous;

- a public correction note on the publisher's website.

We do not claim to be exhaustive. We do claim to be current. New editions are issued whenever a £1,000+ scheme change is published.